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Contact
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EMPLOYMENT ◇ **Associate Professor** Oct 2020 – present
Instituut voor Sterrenkunde, KU Leuven.

◇ **Research Scientist** Mar 2016 – Sep 2020
STAR Institute (PSILab/FNRS/CSL), University of Liège.

◇ **Research Associate** Sep 2012 – Feb 2016
Steward Observatory, University of Arizona

◇ **Postdoctoral Fellow** Jan 2010 – Aug 2012
Max Planck Institute for Radio Astronomy

◇ **FNRS/FRIA PhD student** Oct 2005 – Dec 2009
STAR Institute (AEOS), University of Liège.

◇ **ESA Trainee** Feb 2005 – May 2005
Advanced Concepts Team at ESTEC (ESA)

PROFESSIONAL ◇ **Associate partner** of the [VLTI/GRAVITY+](#) consortium (2020 - present)

EXPERIENCE ◇ **Science Team Member** of [ELT/METIS](#) (2019 - present), the LEECH exoplanet survey (2012-2016), and the HOSTS exozodi survey (2012 – 2020).

◇ **ULiège Project Manager** for ELT/METIS (2019 - 2020).

◇ **Designated Campus Colleague** at Steward Observatory (University of Arizona, 2019 – 2020).

◇ **Principal Investigator** of the [NOTT interferometer project](#) (2017 – present).

◇ **Technical Lead** of the [Large Interferometer For Exoplanets](#) (LIFE, 2018 – 2023)

◇ **Instrument Scientist** of the [Large Binocular Telescope Interferometer](#) (2012 – 2016).

◇ **Night astronomer** for the Large Binocular Telescope Interferometer (100+ observing nights, 2012 – 2016).

◇ **Fizeau visitor** of the European Commission (FP6 and FP7) at the “Institut de Planétologie et d’Astrophysique de Grenoble” (2007, 2010, and 2012) and “ETH Zurich” (Swiss Federal Institute of Technology, 2019).

◇ **External expert** on the DARWIN/TPF project for ESA/ESTEC (2005 – 2006) and NASA/JPL (2007 – 2008).

◇ **Chairman** of a [satellite meeting](#) at the “Pathways to habitable planets” conference on the “Prevalence of exozodiacal dust” (~50 participants, Bern 2015).

◇ Workshop organization ([Hi-5 kickoff meeting](#), [LIFE kickoff meeting](#), [LIFE workshop at Lorentz center](#), [Asgard workshop](#), [Asgard/NOTT exozodi workshop](#)).

◇ 260+ publications including 95 refereed in astronomy journals (including 4 in *Nature*).

◇ 20+ oral presentations at international conferences with a selection committee.

EDUCATION ◇ **Ph.D. in Science**, orientation Astrophysics, University of Liège, December 2009.
Thesis: *Detection of exozodiacal dust: a step toward Earth-like planet characterization with infrared interferometry*. (Supervisors: Pr. Surdej, Dr. Absil)

	◇ M.Phil. in Science (highest honors, PGD), orientation Astrophysics, University of Liège, September 2007. Thesis: <i>Performance study of space-based infrared nulling interferometers</i>. (Supervisors: Pr. Surdej, Dr. Absil) ◇ Civil Engineer in Physics (highest honors, PGD), University of Liège, June 2005. Thesis: <i>Implications of the Pioneer anomaly for the Laser Interferometer Space Antenna (LISA)</i>. (Supervisors: Pr. Swings, Dr. Rathke)
SKILLS	◇ Expert in high-contrast interferometry and exozodiacal disks ◇ Astronomical observations/operations: visible to mid-IR imaging, interferometry, integral field and slit spectroscopy ◇ High-contrast imaging and interferometry data reduction and analysis ◇ Adaptive optics/wavefront sensing and control: operations, laboratory experiments, and simulations ◇ End-to-end instrument simulations and optimization ◇ French (native), English (proficient), Dutch (level B2), and German/Spanish (basic) ◇ Fluent in various scientific (IDL, Python, MATLAB, C/C++, Fortran) and web-oriented (Html5, PHP, MySQL, Javascript) programming languages
AWARDS AND GRANTS	◇ NASA Honor Group Achievement Award, together with the HOSTS team (2020) ◇ NASA Honor Group Achievement Award, together with the NASA/JPL team (2019). ◇ ERC Consolidator grant for the SCIFY project (2019). ◇ Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Seal of Excellence (2017). ◇ FNRS scientific collaborator grant (2017-2018). ◇ OPTICON-H2020 Joint Research Network grant (2016). ◇ Max Planck Society grant for independent research (2010). ◇ Fizeau Exchange Visitors Grant of the European Interferometry Initiative (4 times). ◇ FNRS/FRIA Graduate Fellowship (2005-2009). ◇ Odissea Award of the Belgian Senate for the diploma thesis (2005). ◇ J. Genard Award of the Astrophysics Department at University of Liege (2005). ◇ Pisart grant (merit-based scholarship awarded every year to engineering students at the University of Liege, 2005).
TEACHING ACTIVITIES	◇ Observational techniques in Master of Astronomy and Astrophysics (link, KU Leuven). ◇ Planetary Systems in Master of Astronomy and Astrophysics (link, KU Leuven). ◇ Invited Lecturer in “Space experiment development” (link, University of Liege). ◇ Invited Lecturer at Caltech’s Sagan Exoplanet Workshop: “Imaging Planets and Disks”. ◇ Substitute Lecturer in “Astrophysics and space techniques” (Prof. J. Surdej). ◇ Supervisor of 9 master theses and 4 PhD theses. ◇ Jury member of 14 PhD theses in Astrophysics.
COMMUNITY SERVICE	◇ Member of ESO’s Time Allocation Working Group for the ELT (2026 – present). ◇ Member of ESO’s Users Committee (2025 – present). ◇ Bureau member of the European Interferometry Initiative (EII) (link, 2020 – present). ◇ Coordinator of the Belgian VLTI expertise center (link, 2018 – present).

- ◇ **ESO OPC panel member** (2017 – 2018).
- ◇ **Scientific referee** for major astronomy journals (Nature, ApJ, A&A, PASP, JATIS).
- ◇ **ULiège representative** at Belgian National ESO Committee (2016 – 2020).
- ◇ **Participant or Organizer** of outreach activities at the Science Spring Break, a yearly science meeting for school kids.
- ◇ **Invited lecturer** at several general public conferences (Liège, Paris, Lyon, Tucson).

PRESS
RELEASES

- ◇ *Dancing on the edge of a black hole: Meet S301, the star near the heart of our Milky Way*, [ESO news](#) (2026).
- ◇ *Laser trial run kickstarts new era of interferometry*, [ESO news](#) (2025).
- ◇ *Weighing a black hole in the early universe*, [ESO news](#) (2024).
- ◇ *Launch of Europe’s largest astronomy network*, [CNRS news](#) (2021).
- ◇ *Stellar Dust Survey Paves Way for Exoplanet Missions*, [NASA](#) (2nd author, 2018).
- ◇ *Multi-phase volcanic resurfacing at Loki Patera on Io*, [Forbes](#) (2017).
- ◇ *Scientists caught a new planet forming for the first time ever*, [The Washington Post](#) (2015).
- ◇ *An image of a whole planetary system*, [Max Planck Society](#) (2015).
- ◇ *Lava Lake on Moon of Jupiter Revealed in Remarkable Detail*, [National Geographic](#) (2015).
- ◇ *Telescope To Seek Dust Where Other Earths May Lie*, [NASA/JPL](#), [ULg](#) (1st author, 2015).
- ◇ *VLTI Detects Exozodiacal Light*, [ESO](#) (3rd author, 2014).
- ◇ *Astronomers Gear Up to Discover Earth-like Planets*, [Astrobiology](#) (2nd author, 2013).
- ◇ *Dust near the habitable zone of stars*, [CNRS](#) (2nd author, 2013).

SELECTED
INVITED
TALKS

- ◇ *Asgard/NOTT: status and synergies with MATISSE*, invited talk at the MATISSE science days, Budapest, 2026.
- ◇ *Review of high-contrast optical stellar interferometry*, invited talk at the SPIE meeting, San Diego, 2020.
- ◇ *Thermal background calibration with LBTI*, invited talk at the ”thermal infrared observations” workshop, Munich, 2020.
- ◇ *Technological challenge for the Large Interferometer For Exoplanets*, invited talk at ESTEC, Noordwijk, 2019.
- ◇ *Characterizing exoplanetary atmospheres with a mid-infrared nulling spectrograph*, invited talk at Astrobiology meeting, Brussels, 2017.
- ◇ *Proxima Cen b: theoretical spectral signatures for different atmospheric scenarios*, invited talk at EWASS, Prague, 2017.
- ◇ *Theory and early results of the Large Binocular Telescope Interferometer*, invited lecture at the Sagan Exoplanet Summer Workshop, Los Angeles, 2014.
- ◇ *Infrared interferometric detection of exozodiacal dust: status and prospects*, invited seminar at Caltech/IPAC, Los Angeles, 2013.
- ◇ *Infrared interferometric observations with the VLTI*, invited seminar at the University of Chile, Santiago, 2012.
- ◇ *Near-infrared interferometric observations of nearby debris disks*, invited seminar at the “Paris Observatory - LESIA”, Paris, 2011.
- ◇ *Interferometric observations in astronomy*, invited talk at the “grande conférence de l’institut d’astrophysique de Lyon”, Lyon, 2011.
- ◇ *Detection of exozodiacal dust: a step toward Earth-like planet characterization with infrared interferometry*, invited talk at the “grande conférence de l’institut d’astrophysique de Paris”, Paris, 2010.

- ◇ *Observing extrasolar planetary systems with infrared interferometry*, invited seminar at the Astrophysical Institute, Jena University, 2009.
- ◇ *Pioneer anomaly: what can be learned from LISA?*, invited talk at the “Laser, Clocks and Drag-Free: technologies for future exploration in space and tests of gravity”, ZARM, Bremen, 2005.